

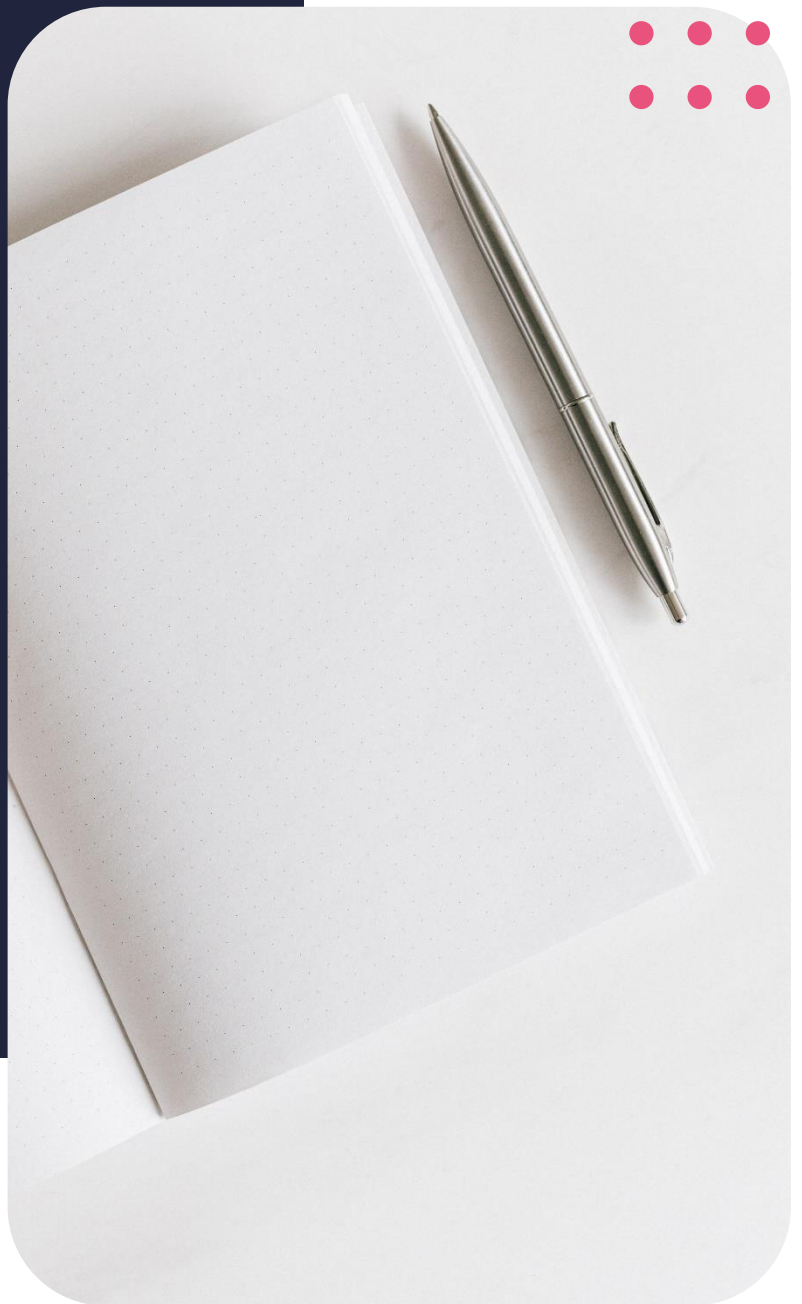
Diploma in Leadership & Management

Lead any Team with Confidence and Strategy



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Lesson 1 Objectives

- Why does team leadership matter?
- Tools to better manage your team
- How to effectively delegate

Lesson Introduction

Individual commitment to a group effort. That is what makes a team work, a company work, a society work, a civilization work.

- Vince Lombardi

The aim of the summary notes is to go beyond the lesson content and give you more insight when it comes to team leaders. We will explore some collaboration tools, project management tools and great ways to motivate your team.

Key reading materials

- <https://courses.lumenlearning.com/wm-organizationalbehavior/chapter/types-of-teams/>
- <https://wheniwork.com/blog/management-skills>
- <https://www.fm-magazine.com/news/2020/jan/how-new-managers-fail-201922251.html>

Amazing collaboration tools for your team

According to (Economy, 2020) please note that these are direct reviews regarding the different software options. Here you have amazing tools and software that you can make use of to better manage your team. These options look at collaboration tools as well as project management tools. Have a look at the different options and explore which ones you think will best suit the needs of your team.

1. Flowdock

Flowdock is a group and private chat platform. Its most interesting feature is its team inbox which aggregates notifications from other channels, like Twitter, Asana, and customer support tools.

2. GoToMeeting

GoToMeeting is an online video conferencing software that allows users to schedule meetings and share screens. It's one of the most popular video tools with millions of users.

3. Slack

Slack is a popular and well-crafted platform offering instant messaging, file transfers, and powerful message search. It has many features and dozens of integrations with other tools like Trello and Intercom.

4. WebEx

3 Cisco's WebEx provides personalized video meeting rooms where users can host and join meetings. People can use WebEx for team collaboration, webinars, training, and customer support. Manage projects and tasks
Project management tools are critical. Who can coordinate effectively when they can't monitor task progress or keep track of objectives?

5. Asana

One of the most well-known project management tools, Asana allows users to assign tasks to other members, add followers to projects, and monitor deadlines. It's very useful as a to-do list or calendar for strategic planning.

6. Dapulse

Dapulse is a collaboration tool that helps you communicate, set objectives, and assign tasks. Its big advantage: it has a great visual design so it's easy to understand and work with.

7. ProofHub

ProofHub is a work management tool that offers a comprehensive suite of collaboration and project management functions. On this platform, you can organize files, plan and monitor projects, and discuss with colleagues and stakeholders. ProofHub also lets you review and approve files through an online proofing tool.

8. Redbooth

Redbooth is an easy-to-use project management tool. Its platform allows users to plan and collaborate through many functions from video conferencing to creating Gantt charts.

9. Trello

Trello has an intriguing interface that resembles solitaire (you can even drag task cards across columns, just like you would playing cards). It's easy to learn and works well for monitoring projects and assigning tasks. Trello also makes using Agile, Scrum and other project management frameworks easy.

What are some of the best ways to motivate your team?

According to (Economy, Super Effective Ways to Motivate Your Team, 2020) team leadership is a process that you use to motivate, inspire, and get results from your employees. As part of team management or leadership, rewards and incentives are needed. You can have amazing structures in place but without rewards and recognition, employees can lose focus or motivation. Here are some ways that leaders can set up rewards for their teams and the individuals in those teams.

Invest in self-development opportunities

Studies have shown the high impact of self-development when it comes to employee engagement, improvement, and retention. Employees want the room to grow and they need companies to offer development. When you see an employee with leadership potential, give him or her the opportunity to take a course and take on new responsibilities at work.

Team rewards

Set up rewards, KPIs, or incentives for when the team does well as a unit. This helps employees stay motivated to collaborate and work to achieve their goals together. You want to have your team win and lose as a unit instead of competing. This also plays into your team culture that is coming up later in this module.

Passion projects are needed

A lot of companies make use of passion projects to motivate individual team members. Team members can invest in projects that they care about what piques their interest. This is amazing as employees feel less bored at work and they get to do something outside of their day-to-day routine. Employees can be creative and can also bring different projects to the team that can bring no dynamics to your team.

Empower employees

It is important to give employees room to make decisions and to learn from their mistakes. Employees need a chance to make decisions and see what the outcome will be. A lot of managers and leaders leave employees to make decisions without giving employees enough power and information to be successful. Set your employees up for success and not a failure. Train them to problem solve and give them enough information to make the correct decisions.

How can you be more effective at delegation?

According to (Randall, 2019): 'Delegating is a great way to ensure that more tasks get done in less time, and it also builds team capacity. Unfortunately, a lot of managers don't pay enough attention to the delegation process, and thus fail to reap the benefits.'

Here are some things you can do to be better at delegating.

Prepare

You need to prepare yourself to let go and to prepare your employees to be ready for delegation. Employees need to feel empowered and that they have the right amount of support, power, and knowledge to make informed decisions. They also must feel like their decisions, good or bad without being fired. Employees need room to grow and they need a leader that gives them the opportunity to grow.

Assign

Now that you have prepared both yourself and your employees, it is time to give them an assignment and test the waters. Allow employees to take on a project and to start calling the shots. When you assign the project or task, make sure to give all the information, due dates, responsible parties, and resource updates as needed. You also must outline your expectations and the types of communication you are looking for.

Confirm that employees have committed to the process

'This is another part of the delegation process that most managers skip. They often just assume that employees have accepted the tasks they've been given. The most important part of a relay race is the handing of the baton to the next runner. Runners spend a huge amount of time learning this 7 skill. It should be no different in the workplace. Commitment means making sure you've successfully handed over the baton.' As stated by (Randall, 2019).

Accountability

As stated by (Randall, 2019) accountability is key to the process of delegation: It means employees are regularly communicating with you about the status of the deliverable and the timing of delivery so that there are no surprises at the eleventh hour. The delegation process becomes faster and more fluid the more you do it. Once you have mastered it, it will become a part of your managerial DNA, and you'll consistently reap outstanding results.

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